you have a certain business goal in mind – let's say a six-figure turnover – but the pursuit of that goal is damaging your relationship with clients and customers and decreasing the lifespan or value of your business long term, this is also not a great idea. So, it's worth bearing in mind that, particularly with money, more and sooner is not always better, and setting your goals around sustainable progress is probably the right way to go.

The first thing to look at, when you start to consider your financial goals, is your inspiration. In pinning specific goals to a bigger-picture idea of what you want your future to look like, you give your goals texture, context and meaning. This, in turn, is motivating – if you can imagine how hitting a particular goal will improve your experience of life, whether that's affording you a nicer lifestyle, giving you more time or adding to your freedom, you will be more likely to actually follow through with them.

The second step is to look at your current situation, always acknowledging the positives, of course, and examine the gap between where your finances are, and where you'd like them to be. The size of that gap will influence how ambitious your goals need to be, and will also, to some extent, dictate the timescale for creating your goals. Make sure that, in doing this, you don't start to resent your current situation – remember that this is all a journey, and that the ability to set goals and look forward with positivity is, in itself, a huge achievement.